
Introduction

One of the goals of transdisciplinary projects is to **create impact through collaboration**. Thanks to the rich cooperation between different parties, the outcome has a greater chance of being effective. However, change doesn't happen overnight.

You can read more about achieving and ensuring **long-term, sustainable impact** on the **theory page**.

Check the **practice page** for approaches used by others.

Theory

Multiple types of outcomes—both visible and invisible—must evolve to create transformation. Since projects are usually relatively short (ranging from a week to ten weeks, or maybe a year), it's important to consider **sustainable ways** to use, preserve, and further develop the knowledge, products, or skills gathered.

Sustainable Relationships

One key factor is maintaining **sustainable relationships**. For example, if a project takes place in a neighborhood involving students, researchers, and residents, it can be harmful to enter and leave the area in a short time. A solution could be to have a teacher, researcher, or facilitator work with the neighborhood over a longer period. This allows for a deeper understanding of the area and helps build **trust** with residents. The need for longer-term relationships may also exist between participants, such as between students and societal partners. The latter may decide to

collaborate with the former over the long term.

Relay Learning

To avoid superficial outcomes based on short-term study or collaboration, there is the option of **relay learning**. This means that a transdisciplinary team continues working on the outcome delivered by a previous team. This offers the opportunity to understand, define, or address the complex problem in a more grounded way. It's also a form of collaboration between different teams—though not simultaneously. When choosing this model, it's important to **carefully transfer** the information, knowledge, or actions previously created.

Practice

This page is still under development. Examples will follow soon.

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